VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE SPACEX DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on SpaceX launches, Starlink, AI and the SPCX stock

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF WED OCT 14 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

A Starshield speed limit hits Ukraine's front line; Musk says Washington decides

Ukrainian officials said military Starshield terminals were restricted while moving overnight into Wednesday, slowing drones and ground robots. "Starshield systems are owned and controlled by the US government. Any limits on speed or usage are decided by the US military and ultimately POTUS," Elon Musk replied to Ukraine's Mykhailo Fedorov, who had said connectivity at up to 160 km/h was being restored.

Cargo Dragon is due to dock at the International Space Station (ISS) at about 11 a.m. EDT today, and a Falcon 9 is scheduled to launch the USSF-481 mission from California at 7:44 p.m. EDT. SPCX fell 2.80% to $152.16 as a hot inflation report hit AI-linked stocks. There were no new SEC filings.

I · HUMAN SPACEFLIGHT & LAUNCHES

Dragon arrives this morning; USSF-481 flies tonight

No SpaceX launches since CRS-35 on Tuesday; two events today.



Technicians at Kennedy Space Center lower a pair of ISS Roll-Out Solar Arrays onto a platform on Aug. 11, 2026, ahead of their launch on CRS-35.
PHOTO: NASA/CLAYTON ROUGELOT · PUBLIC DOMAIN

CRS-35 docking, about 11 a.m.

Dragon is set to dock autonomously at the space-facing port of the Harmony module at about 11 a.m. EDT, with NASA coverage from 9:15 a.m. EDT, NASA said. It carries more than 6,300 pounds of supplies and research, including the last pair of ISS Roll-Out Solar Arrays in its trunk (NASA).

USSF-481, 7:44 p.m.

Falcon 9 is scheduled to launch the classified USSF-481 mission for the US Space Force, also called TH-2, from Space Launch Complex 4 East at Vandenberg Space Force Base, with the window opening at 7:44 p.m. EDT, Spaceflight Now lists. Booster B1081, on its 28th flight, will target the drone ship Of Course I Still Love You. The Federal Aviation Administration's (FAA) operations plan shows a primary window from 7:44 p.m. to 12:27 a.m. EDT and a backup on Friday.

II · UPCOMING FLIGHTS

USSF-481 tonight; Bandwagon-5 on Monday

Every SpaceX launch on the books for the next two months, with how firm each date is and where it comes from. Times are Eastern Daylight Time (EDT); date changes are noted in the mission column.

DATE / TIME (EDT)	VEHICLE	MISSION	PAD	STATUS	SOURCES
Tonight, Thu Oct 15, 7:44 p.m.	Falcon 9	USSF-481, US Space Force; booster B1081, 28th flight	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Spaceflight Now; FAA
Mon Oct 19, 6:30 a.m.	Falcon 9	Bandwagon-5 mid-inclination rideshare	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Tentative	Launch Library 2

Tue Oct 20, 6:14 p.m.	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-15; booster B1063, 36th flight	Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
Sat Oct 24, 1:29 a.m.	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-16	Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
NET November	Falcon 9	Cygnus NG-25 cargo to the ISS	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Preliminary	Launch Library 2
NET Sun Nov 8	Starship	Flight 15, Ship 42 and Booster 22; Musk says a ship catch will be attempted	Pad 2, Starbase, Texas	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)
NET Thu Dec 10	Starship	Flight 16 (Starlink Group 30-1), likely Ship 43 and Booster 23	Possibly LC-39A, Kennedy	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)

Status: Confirmed means the operator or NASA has announced the date and time. Tentative means a specific date appears in published schedules but has not been confirmed by SpaceX or its customer. Preliminary means only a no-earlier-than (NET) month or an unofficial target. Sources: Launch Library 2 (The Space Devs), whose times are unofficial; NASASpaceflight, citing range-planning (CADENA) slides. FAA airspace windows: USSF-481 (TH-2) 7:44 p.m. to 12:27 a.m. EDT, backup Friday; Bandwagon-5 6:30 to 8:13 a.m. EDT Monday; Starlink 15-15 6:14 to 10:57 p.m. EDT Tuesday; Starlink 15-16 1:29 to 6:12 a.m. EDT Saturday, October 24. No dates moved since Wednesday's issue. Pads: Space Launch Complex 4 East (SLC-4E), Space Launch Complex 40 (SLC-40), Launch Complex 39A (LC-39A).

III · STARLINK

"Usage of Starlink is limited to civilian or defensive activities"

Ukrainian units said terminals on fast-moving drones and vehicles were slowed without notice; Poland's foreign minister weighed in.



A faint string of Starlink satellites crosses the night sky above the town hall in Tübingen, Germany, on April 24, 2020.
PHOTO: DKTUE · WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC0

"On the night of October 14, without prior notice to the Defense Forces, SpaceX unilaterally restricted the operation of Starshield terminals while in motion," a Ukrainian defense ministry official told reporters in Kyiv, Politico reported; problems occurred at speeds from 72 to 161 km/h depending on the vehicle and unit. Ukrainian drones lost some of their speed, AP reported. The decision was not a high-level US policy decision, two US officials told CNN.

Musk wrote that Starlink "is a commercial service owned and controlled by SpaceX," limited "to civilian or defensive activities." "Hey, @elonmusk, big man, are you playing politics with your products again? As your European customers, we are watching you," Polish Foreign Minister Radosław Sikorski posted; Poland funds more than 29,000 Starlink terminals in Ukraine, Interfax-Ukraine reported. Late Wednesday Musk posted "Time for Zelensky to go."

QUICK HIT

Curaçao. Starlink service is now available in Curaçao, Musk posted on Wednesday.

IV · AI & COMPUTE

Grok Voice 3.0, and Amazon shuts out Grok Bot

SpaceXAI released Grok Voice 3.0, which it called "the world's most intelligent speech-to-speech model," saying it "responds in under a second, and costs less than other frontier models"; Musk quoted the announcement. It debuted first on the Artificial Analysis Speech to Speech Index with a score of 86.9, according to a post Musk shared.

A user posted that Amazon had blocked a Grok Bot from ordering, citing "unauthorized AI agent" access. "Just ask Grok @Bot to buy what you want someplace else and get a better deal," Musk replied. Separately he wrote: "If Grok @Bot makes a mistake with a purchase or leaks your card (never happened yet), SpaceX will make you whole." SpaceXAI testifies before the New York City Council's Committee on Technology tomorrow at 10 a.m. EDT (amNY).

Starbase scoping is open; nothing new at the SEC

Wednesday's FAA notice on up to 456 Starship launches a year opened a comment period that runs to November 30.

FAA

Notice of intent · Oct 14 — The FAA will prepare a Programmatic Environmental Impact Statement (PEIS) on SpaceX's proposal to increase Starship-Super Heavy operations at the Boca Chica launch site at Starbase and to add Starship landing and expenditure locations (docket FAA-2026-12808; 91 FR 65289). Later license changes and temporary airspace closures fall within its scope. Federal Register

What is proposed — Phase 1 allows up to 100 launches and 200 landings a year, at any time on any day; Phase 2, expected within several years, raises the cap to 456 launches and 912 landings, with launches on weekdays only, Invezz reported. The current limit is 25 launches and 50 landings. Four in-person scoping meetings are set for November 17 and 19 and a virtual one for November 18; comments are due November 30, SpacePolicyOnline reported.

Notice of intent · Sep 29 — Scoping comments on Starship at Space Launch Complex 37, Cape Canaveral (up to 76 launches a year), closed Wednesday (docket FAA-2026-10792). Federal Register

SEC

> No filings for Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (CIK 0001181412) were accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system (EDGAR) between 8:00 a.m. EDT Wednesday and 8:30 a.m. EDT Thursday. Latest insider filings:

Form 4/A · Sep 30 · Antonio Gracias, director — Amends his report of the September 11 in-kind distribution of 42,790,223 shares by Valor entities; 460,624,307 shares afterward. Filing

Form 4 · Sep 24 · Gwynne Shotwell, President and Chief Operating Officer — Exercised options for 342,170 shares on September 22 and sold the same number at weighted-average prices of $151.15 to $154.72; 2,472,035 shares afterward. Filing

FCC

Oct 8 · 800 MHz purchase — SpaceX's purchase of Grain's nationwide 800 MHz licenses is subject to FCC approval. Grain

Oct 6 · Gen2 direct-to-device order — 15,000 satellites granted in part; surety bond due November 4. Exterra

Oct 29 · Open meeting — Votes on more spectrum for Supplemental Coverage from Space and a proposed 25 MHz auction. Broadband Breakfast

Takeaways

1. Ukraine says Starshield terminals were slowed in motion; Musk says the US government controls Starshield limits.
2. Cargo Dragon docks at the ISS about 11 a.m. EDT today.
3. USSF-481 launches from Vandenberg tonight at 7:44 p.m. EDT.
4. SpaceXAI launched Grok Voice 3.0 and testifies to the New York City Council Friday.
5. SPCX fell 2.80% to $152.16 in a broad selloff.

SOURCES

Posts by @elonmusk on X; NASA, Spaceflight Now, FAA, Federal Register, Launch Library 2, NASASpaceflight; Politico, AP, CNN, Interfax-Ukraine, amNY, Invezz, SpacePolicyOnline, Grain Management, Exterra, Broadband Breakfast; SEC EDGAR; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: NASA (public domain); Dktue via Wikimedia Commons (CC0).

The SpaceX Dispatch is an independent weekday digest of public news, X posts, regulatory filings and market data about Space Exploration Technologies Corp., and is not affiliated with the company. Quotes are verbatim; emoji in quoted posts are omitted for print. Market data are delayed and may be revised. Not investment advice.

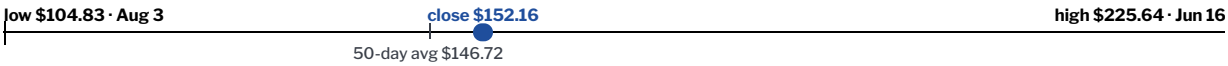
Another 2.8% lower as inflation hits AI stocks

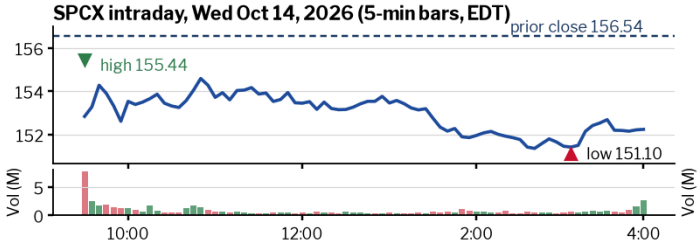
A hotter-than-expected consumer price report pushed yields up and hit capital-intensive AI stocks, Reuters reported; SPCX fell 2.80% and the Nasdaq 100 2.02%.

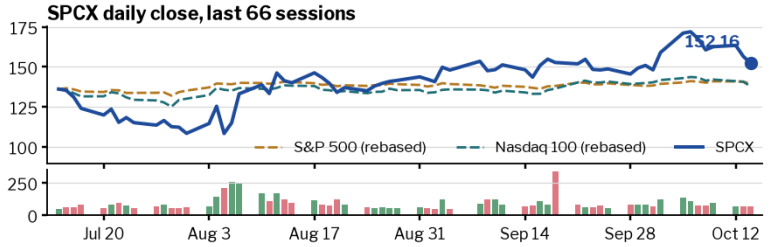
CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$152.16	−$4.38	$154.98	$155.44	$151.10
Wed Oct 14, 4:00 p.m. EDT	−2.80% vs $156.54	regular session	9:30 a.m. EDT bar	3:05 p.m. EDT bar

VOLUME	RANGE SINCE IPO	MARKET CAP	5-DAY / 1-MONTH	SINCE LISTING
67.39M	$105–$226	$2.01T	−9.21% / +6.04%	+12.7%
−26.0% vs 30-session avg 91.02M	no 52-week history (listed Jun 12)	13.18B Class A+B shares × close; $2.07T with Cursor shares	5 and 21 sessions	vs $135 IPO price; −5.46% vs first close

SINCE IPO, OCT 14







As of close Oct 14, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 14 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	SINCE JUN 12
SPCX	**−2.80%**	**−9.21%**	**+6.04%**	**−5.46%**
S&P 500	−1.11%	−1.06%	+1.76%	+3.86%
Nasdaq 100	−2.02%	−3.88%	+3.50%	+1.07%
RKLB	−7.85%	−17.71%	−6.88%	−42.20%
ASTS	−10.46%	−30.52%	−28.30%	−48.86%
IRDM	−2.03%	−5.33%	−2.78%	−3.25%

OPTIONS SNAPSHOT (CBOE, RETRIEVED THU OCT 15, 8:26 A.M. EDT)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 16	436,289	414,990	0.95	56.2%	$165 / $100
Oct 19	36,610	22,673	0.62	44.0%	$170 / $148
Oct 21	13,386	7,081	0.53	46.5%	$170 / $147
All expiries	**2,423,126**	**2,433,832**	**1.00**		**30-day IV index 53.8**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 15

Strong buy	8
Buy	22
Hold	5
Sell	3
Strong sell	0
Mean (1 = strong buy)	1.79
Mean target (31 analysts)	$221.26 (+45.4%)
Median target	$225.00
High / low target	$450.00 / $118.00

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	181.00M
Change vs. prior report	+4.2%
Short % of float	2.71%
Days to cover	2.01
Held by insiders	12.73%
Held by institutions	48.52%
Alphabet, Jun 30	7.16%
Valor Management, Jun 30	6.54%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 14 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS −$1.10)	—
Forward P/E (EPS est. $1.99)	76.5
Price/sales (rev. $23.04B)	87.0
Beta	—
50-day average	$146.72 (+3.7%)
200-day average	—
Q3 EPS est. (16 analysts)	$0.17
Q3 revenue est. (17)	$12.98B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 9	Barclays	Overweight (initiated)	$254
Oct 9	TD Cowen	Buy	$200
Oct 8	Erste Group	Hold (initiated)	—
Oct 7	Susquehanna	Neutral	$144 to $173
Sep 30	Macquarie	Outperform	$250
Sep 28	Deutsche Bank	Buy	$235
Sep 28	CLSA	Outperform (initiated)	$250

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Fri Oct 16	Monthly options expiry
Sat Oct 24	**Lock-up tranche: up to 328.4M more**
Thu Oct 29	FCC open meeting: direct-to-device spectrum votes
Tue Nov 3	Q3 results (Yahoo estimate, not confirmed)
Wed Nov 4	FCC surety-bond deadline (15,000 satellites)
Tue Dec 8	180-day lock-up ends

Prices, volume, returns, averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 14). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest (Sep 30), ownership (Jun 30, % of Class A) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Thu Oct 15, 8:26 a.m. EDT; Erste Group via TheFly. P/E is price to earnings per share (EPS); price/sales uses trailing 12-month revenue. A dash marks a measure that does not apply yet: trailing P/E (negative EPS), beta and the 200-day average (listed Jun 12). Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) and IV as of Wednesday's close; P/C is put/call by OI; ATM IV at the $152.50 strike. Shares: 10-Q cover (7,696,293,669 Class A + 5,485,486,276 Class B, Jul 28); $2.07T adds 391,041,680 Cursor merger shares (8-K). IPO price and lock-ups: prospectus (424B4); 1.3B more shares unlock two trading days after Q3 results. FCC dates: Exterra.